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ENGCMP 0610

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Master Story Plan:

Pittsburgh Chinese Cultural Center

1. Campaign Overview

The Culture Spotlight campaign is a multi-platform narrative initiative for the Pittsburgh Chinese Cultural Center (PCCC) designed to bridge the cultural context gap between the PCCC's performances and the broader Pittsburgh community. While the PCCC produces vibrant, high-quality cultural events, their current communications function primarily as event recaps for existing community members. The campaign reframes PCCC's content around a curiosity-first, editorial tone that speaks outward to non-heritage audiences like curious Pittsburghers John and Jane Doe without alienating the existing Chinese American community.

Core Thesis	Pittsburgh has a thriving Chinese cultural community most locals walk past without understanding. PCCC is the bridge and this campaign makes that visible.

Primary Audience	John & Jane Doe — college-educated Pittsburghers in their late 20s/early 30s. Frequent arts-scene attendees. Heavy Instagram and TikTok users. No deep prior exposure to Chinese cultural traditions.

Secondary Audience	Second-generation Chinese Americans (like Raymond) and international students (like Raj) who have cultural familiarity but lack the context of a Chinatown community in Pittsburgh.

2. Central Narrative

Every campaign component functions as a chapter in one story: a curious Pittsburgher encounters something visually striking, learns what it means, feels welcomed into the community, and eventually advocates for it. The repeatable storytelling unit driving this arc

is the cultural spotlight, which employs a 3-part Hook/Context/Invitation structure that adapts across every medium while keeping the narrative logic consistent.

Narrative Arc

Stage	*Audience State*	*Campaign Components*	*Rationale*
1. Discovery	Sees something striking but doesn't understand it	Social Media Post, Infographic, Visual Essay.	Short-form, high visual impact, meets audience on platforms they already use
2. Curiosity	Wants to know more. They will seek the cultural context behind what they saw	Audio Soundscape, video essay	Longer-form content that rewards attention, delivers the 'why' behind the visuals.
3. Belonging	Feel welcome, consider attending events	Campaign landing page.	Centralizes all content, makes the path to participate clear
4. Advocacy	Share events with friends.	Pitch presentation and shareable social assets.	Equips engaged audiences to spread awareness organically.

3. Audience Journey Map

The following explores how each persona moves through the campaign narrative, and which touchpoints are most critical for each.

John and Jane Doe (Primary)

- Encounter a Cultural Spotlight Instagram Reel showing a face-changing opera performer with a curiosity-hook: "Look at how fast this performer changes his masks! Here's the centuries-old art form behind it."
- Discovers the mini podcast while commuting to work retelling the story of the Cowherd and Weaver Girl myth, which hooks them in by comparing the story to Romeo and Juliet and the Pittsburgh night sky. This piece then bridges everything together by introducing the PCCC.
- Sees the video essay promoting the Pittsburgh Chinese Cultural festival and decides to attend it in person and loving it! Shares their photo reels with their friend group.

Raymond Zheng (Second-Generation Heritage)

- Recognizes the lion dances from childhood but learns new cultural context through the Cultural Spotlight segments.

- Feels the campaign validates his experience as it reflects a community he identifies with but doesn't always have words to explain to non-heritage friends.
- Shares the infographic and social posts as a way of sharing his culture with his non-Chinese Pittsburgh friends.

Raj Patel (International Student)

- Discovers the PCCC through Instagram while searching for local events, the visual-essay and infographic give enough context to understand what the organization does.
- Attends the Lunar New Year Gala after seeing the event promoted on the campaign landing page.
- Connects with the visual essay's Mapo tofu entry, having eaten it at lab dinners with Chinese colleagues. The origin story gives him a new talking point about the dish he already loves. The Sichuan connection mirrors his own experience of discovering culture through food.

4. Voice, Tone & Language Strategy

All campaign media follows one editorial voice: warm, curious, story-forward. The test for every piece of media is whether a non-heritage Pittsburgher would feel welcomed or excluded by it.

Current PCCC Voice — Avoid	Campaign Voice — Use
"2024 春节晚会 Lunar New Year Gala highlights! 精彩回顾！"	*"Did you know this performer changes masks in under a second? Here's what bianlian means — and why it matters."*
Inward-facing recap. Bilingual stacking creates visual clutter. Opaque to non-heritage audiences.	Curiosity-first hook. Provides context. Works for any viewer regardless of background.

Chinese translations are provided via language toggle on the website and landing page — never stacked inline with English. This eliminates the visual weight mismatch between Chinese and Latin fonts and signals the campaign speaks outward without erasing the heritage community.

5. Campaign Component Map

Each audience-facing deliverable is mapped below to its narrative stage, story function, and the medium-specific reason it works for that stage. Foundation documents (Proposal, Moodboard, Master Story Plan) are excluded as they are not audience-facing.

Component	Stage	Story Function	Why This Medium
Audio Soundscape	Curiosity → Belonging	Mini-podcast retelling the Cowherd & Weaver Girl myth. Opens with Romeo & Juliet; reframes the Milky Way as a Pittsburgh night sky story; closes with a PCCC event URL.	The only component that carries the audience from Discovery to Belonging in a single sitting. Audio creates emotional intimacy unavailable to visual formats.
Visual Essay / Photo Story	Discovery → Curiosity	6-image essay: "You've Eaten It. Now Meet Where It Came From." Traces dumplings, mapo tofu, chop suey, and scallion pancakes from American-Chinese menus back to their Chinese origins.	Food is John & Jane's most accessible entry point. The familiar → origin → Pittsburgh structure is the Culture Spotlight format applied visually.
Infographic	Discovery	Single-page visual presenting PCCC's scope, impact, and year-round activity. Counters the perception that PCCC is a two-event organization.	Fast to consume and highly shareable. Designed to be the first touchpoint for someone who has never heard of PCCC.
Video Essay / Promo Video	Curiosity → Belonging	60–90 second festival-focused promo built around the Pittsburgh Chinese Cultural Festival Experience: food stalls, performances, activities, etc.	Highest-engagement format on Instagram and YouTube. CTA bridges Curiosity into Belonging by making event attendance one tap away.
Social Media Adaptation	Discovery → Advocacy	5-post Culture Spotlight series: Sichuan opera, lion dance, qipao, paper cutting, chorus. Each post is platform-native and works standalone while building a series.	Meets audiences where they already are. Series format builds a return habit — audiences follow for the next installment, not just a one-time recap.
Portfolio Website / Landing Page	Belonging	Single-page scrolling hub integrating all audience-facing components. Includes language toggle, event calendar link, and clear paths to follow PCCC's channels.	Every other component points here. This is where curiosity converts to attendance and advocacy.
Pitch Presentation	Advocacy	Recorded 5–7 minute Zoom presentation pitching the full campaign to PCCC as a client. Synthesizes all components into one strategic argument.	Forces the campaign's narrative logic to hold up under scrutiny. The most explicit articulation of the campaign's value to PCCC.

6. Sources

[1] Pittsburgh Chinese Cultural Center. “A Remarkable Journey of 10 Years.” YouTube, 4 Oct. 2025.

[2] Pittsburgh Chinese Cultural Center. “Art Troupe.” pghccc.org.

[3] Sprout Social. “New Social Media Demographics.” Sprout Social, 2024.

[4] Meltwater. “Social Media Statistics India.” Meltwater, 2024.

[5–10] Pittsburgh Chinese Cultural Center. Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, website. pghccc.org.